

Microsoft Lumia 640 XLL

Microsoft launches only the third Lumia phablet ever.

The Lumia 640 was accompanied by the larger 640 XL smartphone. This smartphone holds the same internals as the one mentioned above, but with a larger 5.7 inch display.

It's been a while since Microsoft launched a phablet into the market and it is good to see the company filling up its portfolio. The last phablets in the Lumia range were the Lumia 1520 and Lumia 1320. We quite liked both of those phablets, but of course, Windows remained a hitch for them. The OS has grown since then though and the 640XL may very well be a good addition to the Lumia range.

While the processor remains the same, the Lumia 640XL also has a 13MP rear and 5MP front camera along with a bigger 3000 mAh battery over the 640. The device should also be priced in the sub-20k segment, but going by Microsoft's pricing history, it's hard to be sure.

The Lumia 640 XL also comes with the bundled Office 365 subscriptions. This seems to be Microsoft's strategy. The company seems to be betting on the fact that Office and its services will be used by regular users. Microsoft is even making them available on Android and iOS gradually. There are only two possible reasons – either Microsoft is looking to draw users from Android to Windows



using these services, or the company is trying to generate profits through services and leverage that to build the Lumia line. Only time will tell what's what.

SPECIFICATIONS

5.7 inch 720p, 1GB RAM, Qualcomm Snapdragon 400, 13MP rear camera, 5MP front camera, 3000 mAh battery

Price: TBA



Sony Xperia M4 Aqua

Sony seemed to have made a last minute decision to not launch the Xperia Z4 smartphone at this year's MWC. Hence, the M4 Aqua is the beginning to the company's 4 series of Xperia smartphones.

The M4, like many of its predecessors, is waterproof. That said, unlike its predecessors, this is an IP68 certified device that doesn't require flaps to cover its USB port. Sony showed off the smartphone in Barcelona and should be bringing it to India soon.

The Japanese company announced an euro pricing that translates to around Rs. 24,000. This and the fact that it runs on the Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 SoC means that the M4 Aqua would be competing against the HTC Desire 820 and some other smartphones.

The company made no remarks on when the Xperia Z4 flagship would be announced, but we expect it sometime in the second half of the year.

SPECIFICATIONS

5 inch 720p, Qualcomm Snapdragon 615 SoC, 2GB RAM, 13MP rear, 5MP front, 2400 mAh battery

Price: TBA